

Here's the state-by-state picture. A framing note first: **no state on your list affirmatively requires an agency to contact the requestor for clarification of a vague request** — the laws split instead between "may seek clarification, with defined consequences" (WA, NJ, RI), "must offer narrowing before a burden-based denial" (IL — close cousin, not identical), "insufficient description is a denial ground" (MI), and silence (AZ, OK, KS, MS, FL, NC). I'm not a lawyer, and since this feeds jurisdiction profiles with legal-defensibility claims, each profile should get counsel verification before you ship it — consistent with your own "legal research first" rule.

Washington (RCW 42.56.520) — the most complete statutory scheme on your list. Contact requirement: none — the agency *may* ask the requestor to clarify an unclear request as one of its five-business-day response options. Closure without asking: yes, via denial, and denials must be accompanied by a written statement of specific reasons. Clock: additional response time may be based on the need to clarify the intent of the request — so clarification effectively extends the clock — and per case law (Hikel), the clarification letter must still include a time estimate. Requestor-response clock: not in statute, but the AG's model rule (WAC 44-14-04003) says if the requestor does not respond within thirty days or another specified time, the agency may consider the request abandoned and should send a closing letter — the closing letter is advisory ("should"), not mandatory. Non-response closure: yes — if the requestor fails to respond and the entire request is unclear, the agency need not respond to it; otherwise it must respond to the portions that are clear. [State + 5](#)

New Jersey (OPRA, as amended by P.L. 2024, c.16) — contact requirement: none; per the GRC, a custodian may, but is not required to, seek clarification of a broad or unclear request, and the clarification request must be in writing within seven business days of receipt. Closure without asking: yes — a custodian is not required to research files to figure out which records might be responsive to a broad and unclear request, and the 2024 amendments let custodians deny requests that require more than reasonable efforts to clarify; communications requests missing the statutory specificity elements (job title/account, subject matter, a reasonable time period — note the "reasonable" term there) are invalid. Denial requires a written response with legal citation. Clock: seeking clarification counts as a valid response within the statutory seven business days; GRC practice treats the clock as suspended pending the reply, but the statute states no explicit toll. Requestor-response clock: nothing specified. Non-response closure and notification: nothing specified in statute. [State of Michigan + 4](#)

Rhode Island (APRA) — contact requirement: none specified. Closure without asking: denial is available, and any denial must be in writing with reasons and appeal procedures. Clock: yes, explicitly — the response time is tolled pending receipt of payment and/or further clarification pursuant to R.I. Gen. Laws § 38-2-7(b); the AG's own procedures confirm the 10-business-day period (extendable 20 for "good cause") may be tolled pending a request for prepayment or clarification. Requestor-response clock: nothing specified. Non-response closure/notification: nothing specified — in practice a tolled request just sits. [Florida Senate](#)

Illinois (FOIA, 5 ILCS 140) — the mandatory-conference outlier, but scoped to *burdensome categorical* requests rather than vagueness per se. Before invoking the unduly-burdensome exemption on a categorical request, the public body *shall* extend the requestor an opportunity to confer to reduce the request to manageable proportions; if it then denies, it must do so in writing specifying why compliance would be burdensome, and that response is treated as a denial. For pure vagueness the

statute is silent — and Section 3.3 states the Act doesn't compel public bodies to interpret or advise requesters on meaning. Clock: no toll for the conference; the ordinary clock is 5 business days plus one 5-day extension (categorical requests qualify), and the parties may agree in writing to extend. Critically, a body that fails to respond on time may not treat the request as unduly burdensome at all — so waiting silently for clarification forfeits the exemption. Requestor-response clock, non-response closure, notification of same: nothing specified. [Kansas + 3](#)

Michigan (FOIA, MCL 15.233/15.235) — contact requirement: none, and no clarification mechanism exists in the statute at all. The requestor's obligation is to describe the record sufficiently to enable the public body to find it; if the description is insufficient, the body may deny on that ground within the 5-business-day window (one 10-day extension), using written denial notice with explanation and appeal rights — Michigan agencies literally have a checkbox for "request does not describe the record sufficiently to enable this Department to determine what record is sought". Clock: no tolling — the clock is fixed, and failure to respond within it constitutes a final determination to deny. Requestor-response window, closure on non-response: not applicable — the vague request is simply denied (with required notice) and the requestor re-files. [Fultoncountyl + 2](#)

Kansas (KORA, K.S.A. 45-218/45-220) — contact requirement: none specified. The statute lets agencies require the requestor to furnish the information needed to ascertain the records desired, which functions as a clarification hook but imposes no duty. Closure: denial is available (insufficient identification, or unreasonable-burden grounds); a written statement of grounds is required upon the requestor's request. Clock: each request must be acted on as soon as possible, but not later than the end of the third business day; if access isn't granted immediately, the custodian must give a detailed explanation of the cause for delay and the earliest time the record will be available — a clarification letter within 3 days satisfies "acting on" the request, but there's no statutory toll. Requestor-response clock, non-response closure, notification: nothing specified. [PortsmouthRhodeislandofficialrecords](#)

Florida (Ch. 119) — the loosest framework on your list. There is **no response deadline at all**: Chapter 119 contains no express time limit; per court decisions the only permitted delay is the reasonable time allowed to retrieve the record and delete exempt portions — flag that as pervasive "reasonable time" language (the statute also grants inspection at any reasonable time, under reasonable conditions). Contact requirement: none, though custodians must acknowledge requests promptly and respond in good faith, which includes reasonable efforts to determine whether the record exists and where — arguably an implicit nudge toward dialogue, never an explicit duty. Clock toll, requestor-response window, closure on non-response, closure notification: all nothing specified in statute. Agency policy fills the void — e.g., FDLE closes requests if the requestor fails to respond to a clarification inquiry for 30 days — but that's administrative practice, not law, which actually means your product's per-jurisdiction *agency-configurable* clarification window is exactly the right model for Florida.

Arizona (A.R.S. § 39-121 et seq.) — statute requires records be furnished "promptly" (flag: undefined promptness standard, no day-count clock). Contact requirement: nothing specified. Clarification mechanism, tolling, requestor-response window, abandonment closure, closure notice: nothing specified on any of them. Denial gives rise to appeal rights; failure to respond promptly is treated as denial. Everything else is agency practice.

Oklahoma (51 O.S. § 24A.5) — statute requires "prompt, reasonable access" (flag: both operative words are undefined — case law and AG opinions gloss "prompt" as only excluding unreasonable delay). Contact requirement, clarification mechanism, tolling, requestor response window, non-response closure, closure notification: nothing specified on all six dimensions. The most silent statute on your list alongside North Carolina.

Mississippi (§ 25-61-5) — contact requirement: nothing specified. The clock is 7 working days (agencies may adopt shorter by policy), extendable to 14 working days with a written explanation of why more time is needed; denial must be in writing with reasons and kept on file. No clarification mechanism, no tolling provision, no requestor-response window, no abandonment/closure provision — nothing specified on each.

North Carolina (G.S. Ch. 132) — the sparsest of all. Records must be provided "as promptly as possible" (flag: that's the entire timing standard — no day counts). Contact requirement, clarification, tolling, response window, closure on non-response, notification: nothing specified across the board. Denial practice (written reasons) is convention and case-law-driven rather than statutory.

For the jurisdiction-profile schema, the pattern that falls out of this is five fields per state: `clarification_duty` (none anywhere on this list; IL gets a special `narrowing_conference_required_for_burden_denial` flag), `clarification_tolls_clock` (statutory: RI; effective/practice: WA, NJ; none: rest), `requestor_response_days` (statutory: none anywhere; WA has a 30-day *model-rule* default — worth storing as `source=regulatory_guidance`; FL/agency policy varies), `abandonment_closure_allowed` (WA yes by statute; MI/NJ via denial instead; others unspecified → make it agency-configurable), and `closure_notice_required` (WA "should" per model rule; MI/NJ/RI/MS/IL require written denial notices when the vague request is denied outright). The deeper product insight: because six of your eleven states specify *nothing*, the defensible default is your existing toll-reason "clarification pending" plus a configurable response-window tickler and an always-notify-on-close policy — exceeding every statute on the list is never a compliance risk, while the effective-dated config history covers you when a state amends (as NJ just demonstrated). One more time: have each state's profile reviewed by counsel licensed there before a customer relies on it — several of these points (especially NJ post-2024 practice and WA's model-rule status) are exactly the kind of thing that shifts under litigation